

Spades

Card Deck · 4 players in two partnerships · about 45 minutes

House rules written for The Game Room. These are the common rules; plenty of tables play their own variations, so agree on any before you start.

How to play

Deal all 52 cards, 13 each. Each player bids the number of tricks they expect to take; a partnership's bids add up to its contract. A bid of nil means you will take no tricks at all.

The player left of the dealer leads. Follow suit if you can; otherwise play anything. Spades are always trump. Spades cannot be led until one has been played on another suit, unless you hold nothing but spades.

Scoring: make your contract and score 10 points per trick bid, plus 1 per extra trick (a bag). Fall short and lose 10 per trick bid. Every 10 bags costs 100 points. A successful nil scores 100 and a failed nil loses 100; the partner's tricks count separately. First partnership to 500 wins.